

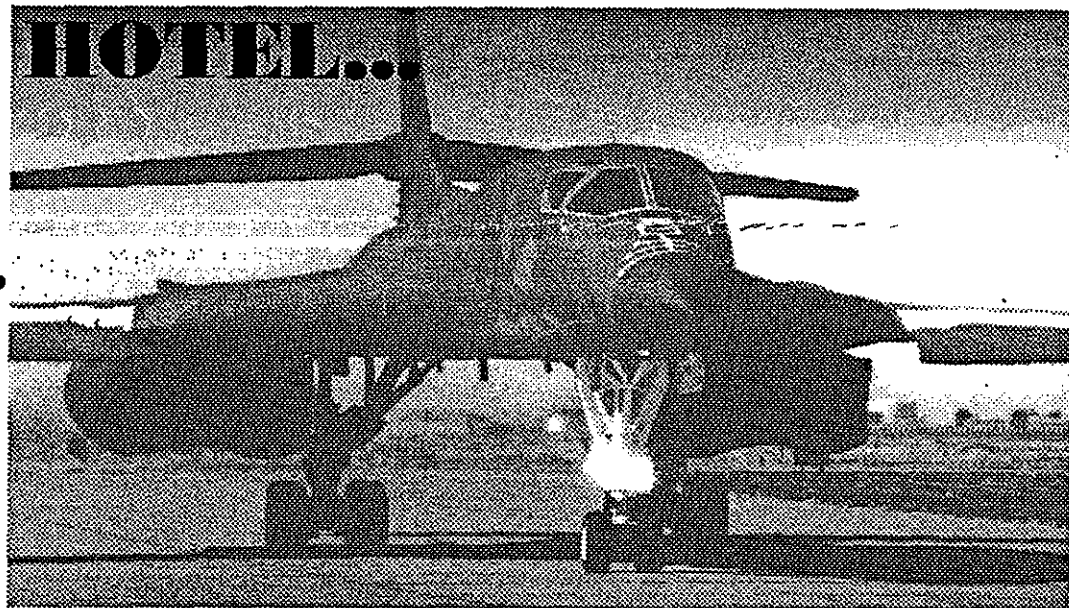
# INTERCEPTS®

AUGUST

NEWSLETTER

1992

## SIERRA HOTEL... Mastering Milspeak And Other Military Voice Brevity Codes



By Steve Douglass

Last month we updated our lists of military callsigns. Since then many of you have also written in for an updated list of military voice brevity codes. For those of you new to military monitoring consider the following listings as a quick course in a foreign language known as Milspeak. Not many of us outside of the military speak it fluently, especially with new terms and definitions being added frequently. The list compiled from many of Intercept's sources and contributors, will undoubtedly help many of us master the language and become linguists of a sort in the strange and cryptic tongue of Milspeak.

| Codes         | Description                                                                                                                     |                   |                                                                                                                                                    |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| AACOMS        | Army area communications systems                                                                                                | Blue Deck         | Flight deck handling medical emergency                                                                                                             |
| Ace High      | NATO Tropospheric scatter communications network                                                                                | Blue Forces       | Forces are friendly                                                                                                                                |
| ACM           | Air Combat Maneuvers                                                                                                            | BMEWS             | Ballistic Missile Early Warning System                                                                                                             |
| AEGIS         | Advanced naval air defense radars system                                                                                        | Bogey             | Enemy aircraft                                                                                                                                     |
| AFSATCOM      | Air Force Satellite Communications                                                                                              | Bolter            | Unsuccessful carrier landing                                                                                                                       |
| AGL           | Above Ground Level                                                                                                              | Break             | Sharp turn or interrupting communications                                                                                                          |
| AIM-7         | Sparrow radar-guided medium-range air-to-air missile                                                                            | Brickwork         | A line of sonobuoys to detect submarine passage                                                                                                    |
| AIM-9         | Sidewinder infrared guided short-range air-to-air missile                                                                       | Broken Arrow      | Nuclear weapon damaged                                                                                                                             |
| AIM-54        | Phoenix radar-guided long-range air-to-air missile                                                                              | Brother           | Attacking ship of surface ASW unit                                                                                                                 |
| ALARM         | Air Launched Alert Response Missile; aircraft launched space booster                                                            | Brownie           | Photo mission                                                                                                                                      |
| ALCC          | Airborne Launch Control Center                                                                                                  | Buff              | B-52 bomber                                                                                                                                        |
| ALCM          | Air Launched Cruise Missile                                                                                                     | Burner            | Afterburner                                                                                                                                        |
| Alligator     | AWACS Secure voice                                                                                                              | Buster            | Continuous maximum flying speed                                                                                                                    |
| Amber Deck    | Flight deck standby condition                                                                                                   | C-3               | Command Control and Communications                                                                                                                 |
| Ammo Minus    | Less than half ammunition left                                                                                                  | C3CM              | Command Control Communications and Counter Measures                                                                                                |
| Ammo Plus     | More than half ammunition                                                                                                       | C3I               | Command Control Communications and Intelligence                                                                                                    |
| AMRAAM        | AIM-120 Advanced Medium Range Air-to-Air Missile                                                                                | CAG               | Commander of air group                                                                                                                             |
| Angles        | Altitude-thousands of feet                                                                                                      | C band            | The radio frequency band of 3.9 to 6.2 gigahertz-band                                                                                              |
| Area 51       | Top secret military weapons test center located on the Nellis Air Force range                                                   | CAP               | Combat Air Patrol                                                                                                                                  |
| ASIS          | Attack Systems Interrogation Station (mission commander's station in B-2 stealth bomber, responsible for navigation and attack) | Casket            | Aircraft crashing or out of control                                                                                                                |
| ASROC         | Nuclear-tipped antisubmarine rocket torpedoes                                                                                   | Charlie           | Correct                                                                                                                                            |
| Assets        | Targets                                                                                                                         | Chatter           | Jamming communications                                                                                                                             |
| Astor         | Anti-submarine torpedo                                                                                                          | Check             | Alter heading momentarily port/starboard                                                                                                           |
| ATF           | Advanced Tactical Fighter                                                                                                       | Check Six         | Look for bogey behind plane                                                                                                                        |
| ATIS          | Automatic Terminal Information Service                                                                                          | CERCOM            | Acronym for Army Communications and Electronics Material Readiness Command                                                                         |
| AUTODIN       | Automatic Digital Network                                                                                                       | Chatter           | Naval aviation voice brevity code meaning communications jamming                                                                                   |
| AUTOSEVCON    | Automatic Secure Voice Communications                                                                                           | Cherubs           | Altitude in hundreds of feet                                                                                                                       |
| AUTOVON       | Automatic Voice Network                                                                                                         | CINC              | Acronym for Commander-In Chief. CINC denotes the highest-ranking military officer in each of the United States military commands                   |
| AWACS         | Aircraft Warning Approach and Control System                                                                                    | CINCSPACECOM      | Commander in Chief, Space Command                                                                                                                  |
| Bag           | Flight suit                                                                                                                     | Chop              | Changing Operational control to another activity                                                                                                   |
| Ball          | Optical landing device on carrier                                                                                               | CIC               | Combat Information Center                                                                                                                          |
| Bandit        | Hostile aircraft                                                                                                                | CIRVIS            | Comms/Instructions for reporting Visual Intelligence Sightings (UFOs)                                                                              |
| Bat Turn      | High-G tight turn                                                                                                               | Clara             | Radar scope clear                                                                                                                                  |
| BDA           | Bomb damage assessment                                                                                                          | Clean             | Inflight configuration without gear/flaps/ordnance extended                                                                                        |
| Beach         | Desert-ground                                                                                                                   | Cold              | Not using live ordnance or lost ASW contact                                                                                                        |
| Beacon Double | On your tracking beacon select double pulse code                                                                                | Cold Nose         | Aircraft operating with radar                                                                                                                      |
| Bead Window   | Communications have been compromised                                                                                            | Collateral Damage | Civilian casualties or untargeted destruction                                                                                                      |
| Beam Rider    | Missile guided by radio or radar                                                                                                | Colossus          | The Sound Surveillance System (SOSUS) that is deployed along the Pacific coast of the United States for the purpose of detecting Soviet submarines |
| Bent          | Inoperative                                                                                                                     | COMOR             | Abbreviation for Committee on Overhead Reconnaissance                                                                                              |
| Bent Spear    | Nuclear accident                                                                                                                | COMPAC            | Designation for man-portable SATCOM terminal                                                                                                       |
| Bingo         | Minimum fuel for safe return                                                                                                    | Confetti          | Radar chaff                                                                                                                                        |
| Bingo Field   | For landing alternate airfield                                                                                                  | COMSEC            | Abbreviation for Communications Security                                                                                                           |
| Bird Dog      | Surveillance aircraft                                                                                                           | CORANDCOM         | Abbreviation for Army Communications Research and Development Command                                                                              |
| Birds         | Guided missiles or satellites                                                                                                   |                   |                                                                                                                                                    |

|               |                                                                                    |                   |                                                                                                 |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cosmic        | Code word for nuclear secrets that are more restricted than top secret information | Jamming           | Green: clear amber: partial red: complete blue: total                                           |
| C.P.          | Command Post (military/police operation)                                           | JCS               | Joint Chief of Staff                                                                            |
| Covered Wagon | Hostile act confirmed                                                              | Joker             | Air contact not hostile                                                                         |
| Crystal Ball  | Radar scope                                                                        | JSTARS            | Joint Surveillance Targeting Acquisition Radar System                                           |
| CZ            | Combat zone                                                                        | Judy              | Have contact and taking over intercept                                                          |
| DARPA         | Abbreviation for Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency                         | Jump              | Combat disengage                                                                                |
| Dash Two      | Second ship in two ship formation                                                  | Kilo              | Frequency change                                                                                |
| Deep Six      | NASA                                                                               | Knock It Off      | Maneuvers or combat-disengage                                                                   |
| DEF CON       | Defense Condition (ranges from 5 for peace to 1 all out war)                       | LF                | Low frequency                                                                                   |
| DEP CON       | Departure Control                                                                  | LAMPS             | Light Airborne MultiPurpose Systems                                                             |
| Devils        | Depth                                                                              | LASA              | Laser Anti-Satellite Weapon                                                                     |
| DEW           | Distant Early Warning                                                              | LASER             | Light Amplification by Stimulated Emission of Radiation                                         |
| DF            | Direction finding equipment                                                        | LASERCOM          | Laser Communications (systems)                                                                  |
| Dip           | Lowering sonar                                                                     | LASINT            | Laser Intelligence                                                                              |
| Dolly         | Airborne data link equipment                                                       | L-band            | Designation for 390 to 1550 MHz                                                                 |
| Double Ugly   | F-4 Phantom                                                                        | Level             | Upper altitude is at designated contact                                                         |
| Down Link     | The rebroadcast signal from a satellite                                            | Liner             | Fly at speed-maximum cruising range                                                             |
| Drone         | Remotely piloted aircraft                                                          | Localize Kilo     | Establish area-Kilo-class sub operates                                                          |
| Duck          | Headed your way                                                                    | Loud Handle       | Releases ejection seat                                                                          |
| Dull Sword    | Nuclear incident                                                                   | Low               | Altitude between 500-2000ft.                                                                    |
| DZ            | Drop Zone                                                                          | Mach              | Speed of sound                                                                                  |
| EAM           | Emergency Action Message                                                           | MAG               | Marine Aviation Group                                                                           |
| ECM           | Electronic Counter Measures                                                        | Many              | Eight or more aircraft-raid size                                                                |
| EHF           | Extremely High Frequency                                                           | Marshall          | Gathering point for approach aircraft                                                           |
| Electric jet  | F-16 Falcon                                                                        | MAW               | Marine Aviation Wing                                                                            |
| ELF           | Extremely Low Frequency 30 to 300 Hz                                               | Mayday            | Distress call                                                                                   |
| ELINT         | Electronic Intelligence                                                            | Medium            | Altitude between 20-5,000ft.                                                                    |
| Elevator      | Altitude indicated in 5000' intervals                                              | Mega Fortress     | EB-52 Strategic "battleship" escort aircraft                                                    |
| ELT           | Emergency Locator Transmitter                                                      | Merge             | When two aircraft or tracks come together                                                       |
| EMP           | Electromagnetic Pulse Burst of energy following nuclear explosion)                 | Metro             | Weather                                                                                         |
| EOD           | Explosive Ordnance Disposal (unit)                                                 | MF                | Medium frequency                                                                                |
| FAA           | Federal Aviation Administration                                                    | Middleman         | Radio relay equipment-VHF or UHF                                                                |
| Faded         | Contact disappeared from scope                                                     | MIGCAP            | Combat air patrol over ground attack aircraft                                                   |
| Faded Giant   | Radiological incident                                                              | Mikes             | Minutes                                                                                         |
| Famished      | Are there any instructions please?                                                 | MIRV              | Multiple Independently targetable Reentry Vehicle                                               |
| Fast Movers   | Jet aircraft                                                                       | Mixup             | A mix of friendly and hostile aircraft                                                          |
| Father        | Activated TACAN                                                                    | MOA               | Military Operations Area                                                                        |
| FEBA          | Forward Edge of Battle Area                                                        | Mother            | Pilot's destination-aircraft carrier                                                            |
| Feet Dry      | Aircraft over beach                                                                | MRE               | Meals ready to eat, jokingly called meals rejected by Ethiopians                                |
| Feet wet      | Aircraft over water                                                                | Mushroom          | Special weapon (nukes?)                                                                         |
| Ferret        | Aircraft gathering electronic intelligence                                         | Music             | Electronic jamming                                                                              |
| Few           | Seven or fewer aircraft                                                            | NAS               | Naval Air Station                                                                               |
| Flight's On   | Air combat beginning                                                               | NCA               | National Command Authorities                                                                    |
| Flash         | Coded message-high priority                                                        | NEST              | Nuclear Emergency Search Team                                                                   |
| FLIR          | Forward-Looking Infrared (Radar)                                                   | No Joy            | No contact                                                                                      |
| FLTSATCOM     | Fleet Satellite Communications (system)                                            | No Lone Zone      | Prohibited area                                                                                 |
| FOD           | Foreign object damage                                                              | NORAD             | North American Aerospace Defense Command                                                        |
| FORSCOM       | Forces Command                                                                     | Nylon Letdown     | Return by parachute                                                                             |
| FSS           | Flight Service Station                                                             | OP                | Orbiting Point                                                                                  |
| Fouled Deck   | Deck not ready to receive aircraft                                                 | On Target         | Fire control director/system acquired/tracking OK                                               |
| Fox           | Missile launching                                                                  | Orange Forces     | Exercise-enemy role forces                                                                      |
| Fox Away      | Missile fired or released from aircraft                                            | Oranges Sour      | Weather unsuitable                                                                              |
| Fox One       | Launching Sparrow missile                                                          | Oranges Sweet     | Weather suitable                                                                                |
| Fox Two       | Launching Sidewinder missile                                                       | Orbiting          | Circle and search or circling                                                                   |
| Fox Three     | Launching Phoenix missile                                                          | OSCAR             | Optical Submarine Communications by Aerospace Relay                                             |
| Fratricide    | Accidentally shooting at one's own troops                                          | OSO               | Offensive Systems Officer (B-1B)                                                                |
| Freak         | Frequency in Mega Hertz                                                            | Pacer Sky         | Satellite based reconnaissance system that transmits real-time infrared, visual, and radar data |
| Freddie       | Controlling unit                                                                   | Pack              | Passengers on board                                                                             |
| Frog          | Free (unguided) rocket over ground                                                 | Paint             | Radar indication                                                                                |
| Furball       | Multi aircraft aerial engagement                                                   | Pan               | Safety Message-very urgent                                                                      |
| Gadget        | Radar equipment                                                                    | Parrot            | I.F.F. equipment                                                                                |
| Gas Passer    | Aerial refueling boom operator                                                     | Pave Paws         | phased-array radars                                                                             |
| Gate          | For limited time fly at maximum speed                                              | Pet Rocks         | Nuclear weapons (unused)                                                                        |
| Gertrude      | Underwater sonar telephone                                                         | Picture Clean     | Radar display-no unfriendly aircraft                                                            |
| GCI           | Ground Controlled Intercept                                                        | Pigeons           | Magnetic bearing and distance from you is ____                                                  |
| Golden BB     | Anti aircraft artillery                                                            | Playground        | Exercise area                                                                                   |
| Goldie        | Flight control/bombing systems ready for ground control                            | Playmate          | Aircraft involved in same mission                                                               |
| Gomer         | Slang for enemy                                                                    | Playtime          | Commence aerial maneuvers                                                                       |
| Gone Elvis    | Missing in action                                                                  | Plug              | Connection with aerial refueler                                                                 |
| GPS           | Global Positioning System                                                          | Pogo              | Return to frequency                                                                             |
| Grand Slam    | Destroyed all enemy aircraft                                                       | Popeye            | Reduced visibility                                                                              |
| Green Deck    | Flight deck clear-launch and recover                                               | Popped            | Killed destroyed                                                                                |
| Guard         | International distress radio frequencies (121.500 MHz, 243.000 MHz, 406.000 MHz)   | Poser             | Pilot with all show and no go                                                                   |
| Hack          | Aircraft used-ferrying pilots                                                      | Pounce            | In position to engage target                                                                    |
| Hanger Queen  | Maintenance problems-aircraft used for parts                                       | Punch             | Intercept target very soon                                                                      |
| Happy Hour    | Return to base-activity complete                                                   | Purple            | Unit suspected in carrying nuclear weapons                                                      |
| HARM          | High-speed Anti-Radiation Missile                                                  | Purple Forces     | Opposing forces-blue & orange (usually subs & aircraft)                                         |
| HAVE QUICK    | Frequency hopping UHF radio system                                                 | Q-band            | Designation for 36,000 to 46,000 MHz                                                            |
| Heading       | Bogey's magnetic course is ____                                                    | Rain              | Radar chaff                                                                                     |
| Helping hand  | Threat of hostile act                                                              | Red Deck          | Flight deck not clear                                                                           |
| HF            | High frequency 1.6 to 30 MHz                                                       | REMF              | Rear-eschelon (mother fu-ers) troops in the rear areas                                          |
| High          | Altitude between 25-50,000 ft.                                                     | RESCAP            | Rescue combat and patrol                                                                        |
| Holding hands | Flying in-formation                                                                | Resume            | Resume last patrol ordered                                                                      |
| Homeplate     | Aircraft's home base                                                               | RIO               | Radar Intercept Officer                                                                         |
| Hot           | Using live ordnance or active ASW contact                                          | Road              | Line of sonobuoys                                                                               |
| HUD           | Heads Up Display                                                                   | Roger             | Message received and understood                                                                 |
| Hummer        | Personnel carrier                                                                  | RON               | Remain overnight                                                                                |
| Hunker        | Prepare for defensive action and maximize terrain masking                          | Sandbags          | Dug in troops                                                                                   |
| ICBM          | Intercontinental Ballistic Missile                                                 | Sand-boy Express  | Ground transport                                                                                |
| Identify      | Identify the contact                                                               | S-BAND            | Radio frequency band of 1550 to 5200 megahertz                                                  |
| Indicating    | Contact speed by plot is ____                                                      | SAM               | Surface to Air-Missile                                                                          |
| IFE           | In Flight Emergency                                                                | SAM (plus number) | Special Air Mission usually denotes dignitary, politician or high ranking military is onboard   |
| In the dark   | Not visible on radar display                                                       | Saunter           | Fly at best fuel consumption                                                                    |
| IFR           | Instrument Flight Regulations                                                      | Scan              | Search sector indicated & report contacts                                                       |
| INS           | Inertial Navigation System                                                         | Scooter           | A-4 Skyhawk                                                                                     |
| IP            | Initial Point or Intercept Point                                                   | Scram             | Keep clear, about to open fire                                                                  |
|               |                                                                                    | Scrub             | Abort mission                                                                                   |
|               |                                                                                    | Scud              | Iraqi long range missile                                                                        |

Scud-buster  
Seek Talk  
Senso  
SHF  
Shine  
Sick  
Sierra Hotel  
Sinker  
Skip It  
Skunk  
SLAR  
SLBM  
SLCM

Snow  
SOB (s)  
Sortie  
Sour  
Splash  
Spoof  
Squawk

SRAM  
STARCOM  
State Chicken  
State Lamb  
State Tiger  
Steady  
Steer  
Stranger  
Strangle  
Sweet  
Sweet Lock  
TACAMO

TACAN  
TACSATCOM  
TANK

TAV  
Tally Ho  
Texaco  
Tied On  
Tips  
Toe Poppers  
Trap  
Trash hauler  
Triple A  
Turn and Burn  
Turkey

Tweet  
UHF  
Vampiro  
Vector  
Very High  
Very Low  
Visited  
VFR  
VHF  
VLF  
Warning Red  
Warning White  
Warning Yellow  
Warp One  
Wave off

Weapons Free  
Weapons Hold  
Weapons Tight  
Weapons Red  
Weapons White  
Weapons Yellow  
Weapons Loose

Well  
Whales  
What State  
Wilco  
Wingman  
Wizzo  
WSO  
Yardstick  
Zip Lip

Zipper  
Zoomie  
Zulu time

Patriot missile  
Designation for secure communications system  
Sensor operator on S-3 Wing  
Superhigh frequency  
Radar or sonar-target is clear  
Equipment problems  
Polite phonetics for Shit Hot  
Radar contact disappearing  
Cease activity  
Unidentified surface contact assumed hostile  
Side-Looking Air-borne Radar  
Submarine-Launched Ballistic Missile  
Submarine (Sea) Launched Cruise Missile  
Sweep jamming  
Souls on board  
Aerial combat mission  
Poorly received  
Shot down aircraft into sea  
Contact employing electronic or tactical jamming  
Send identification friend or foe at code/mode indicated  
Short Range Attack Missile  
Strategic Army Communications  
Fuel state requires recover, refueling, or diversion  
Inadequate fuel for mission & reserve to return  
Sufficient fuel for mission & reserve to return  
Straighten cut heading or on prescribed heading  
Indicate to set magnetic heading  
Unidentified aircraft  
Radio silence  
Good contact  
Good contact & locked on signal  
Designation for Airborne Strategic Communications  
System also known as the airborne radio relay system  
Tactical Air Navigation  
Tactical Satellite Communications  
Joint Chiefs of Staff conference room (also known as Gold Room)  
Trans-Atmospheric Vehicle  
Visual contact  
Air refueling tanker  
Aircraft is in formation  
External fuel tanks  
Land mines  
Arrested aircraft carrier landing  
Cargo aircraft or pilot  
Anti aircraft fire  
Sharp turn at maximum speed  
F-14 Tomcat  
AT-37 attack jet  
Ultrahigh Frequency, which is 200 MHz-3 GHz  
Injured personnel on board  
Alter heading to magnetic (3-digit) degrees  
Altitude above 50,000 ft.  
Altitude below 500 ft.  
Target attacked  
Visual Flight Regulations  
Very high frequency  
Very low frequency  
Attack by hostile aircraft imminent  
Attack by hostile aircraft improbable  
Attack by hostile aircraft probable  
Mach 1  
Abort approach  
Fire at any target not positively identified friendly  
Fire only in self-defense or to a formal order  
Fire only at hostile targets  
(any tight) ready-do not fire for political reasons  
(any tight) ready-fire in self-defense  
(any tight) ready-fire with caution  
Ready-fire at will  
Equipment operating efficiently  
Navy refueling tankers  
Fuel/ammunition/oxygen remaining  
Will comply  
Second pilot in two ship pair  
Radar intercept operator  
Weapons Systems Officer  
Distance to target is  
Routine transmission between aircraft & controllers suspended  
Combat air patrol target down and dusk  
A jet jockey or aviator  
Designation for Greenwich Meridian (Mean) Time

# IN THE WINGS

News For The Military Monitor



Photo via "Dark Star November"

## SPECIAL REPORT

### F-117 CRASH IGNITES RUMORS, SPECULATION

By Steve Douglass

The explosion and crash of a F-117A stealth attack jet did more than light up the night sky around the small New Mexico town of Las Luz, it also fueled rumors and speculation about the mission and payload of these "black" aircraft based at nearby Holloman Air Force Base.

The crash happened about 9:20 PM (Mountain Time) on Tuesday August 4th. The aircraft was on a night training mission when (according to witnesses) it caught fire, exploded, and hit the ground. The pilot, Capt. John B. Mills, ejected safely and only suffered minor injuries from the mishap. He parachuted into the parking lot of a nearby shopping center, walked to a residence near the crash sight, and called Holloman Air Force Base to alert officials to the crash and to report that he was safe. Air Force officials said that Mills was treated for minor injuries at the 49th Fighter Wing Hospital at Holloman.

Witnesses says that there were three separate explosions, one big and two smaller ones. Otero County Deputy Sheriff Leon Ledbetter witnessed the crash and said the aircraft had a "orange glow at the back and a bright white glow at the front" Ledbetter at first thought he was seeing a missile from the nearby White Sands Missile Range, "But it didn't look right," he said. Deputy Ledbetter noted that just before the aircraft crashed he saw a small red streak come out of the top and later realized that it was probably the pilot ejecting. Ledbetter then raced to the scene and was the first law enforcement officer to arrive. "When I pulled up I could see the airplane sitting just northeast of Don Scotts (Radio Communications Company) communications tower. There's a trailer house that sits just to the west of the tower and it was on fire," Ledbetter said.

Volunteer fire units from all over Otero County arrived on the scene shortly after the crash and began fighting the trailer fire. The fire fighters were told to move back, when Holloman crash teams arrived, and until they could determined whether there were any munitions on board the aircraft that might explode. The mobile home was allowed to burn and it was completely destroyed. Several fire fighters were taken to the base hospital and treated for smoke inhalation.

No sooner had the fire been put out then security teams from Holloman began securing and roping off the crash sight. The crash area was declared a "National Security Zone" and the residents near the sight were evacuated to motels. Because of the tight security surrounding the crash, rumors and speculations began to circulate throughout the community. Intercepts began receiving calls from sources at the base, suggesting that there was something "not right" about the crash. Unconfirmed reports and base scuttlebutt ranged from theories that the crash was not a F-117A, to that the aircraft contained nuclear materials and the sight was evacuated due to radiation in the area. The tight security and the lack of public information only fueled these rumors. Adding to the "radiation" scare rumors were the facts that several fire fighters were sent to the base hospital, any civilians in the area of the crash were also asked to report to the base hospital for examination, and men in special toxic chemical suits were seen at the crash site.

The rumors were soon squelched when the real reasons for concern were made public. It seems that the RAM (radar absorbing material) gives off toxic smoke when burned and base officials were concerned that anyone who breathed in the smoke may have been exposed to these toxic gases. Although never

Cont. on pg. 4

## RADIO SHEET MAGAZINE

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Cont. from pg. 3

officially acknowledged, another reason that men in toxic waste removal type suits were at the sight may have been because of a highly classified chemical system used on the F-117 to stop the formation of contrails behind the aircraft. The chemicals used in this system are said to be highly toxic and hazardous to handle. The toxicity of these chemicals are probably the primary reason the residents were evacuated from the area as well as for other security reasons. The Air Force does not want some sight-seer or resident picking up a piece of the super-secret RAM that makes this aircraft virtually invisible on radar.

As for the rumors that it wasn't a F-117A that crashed, there may be some good reasons behind these speculations. Many residents of Alamogordo and other towns near the base have reported seeing strange triangular aircraft flying at dusk over the White Sands Missile Range. Also numerous sonic booms rattle the area several times a week. A recent Aviation Week and Space Technology magazine report says that hypersonic "PDWE" (Pulse Detonation Wave Engines) are possibly being tested on aircraft based at Holloman AFB and Edwards AFB. Supporting these claims are the numerous sightings of the "Pulser" aircraft's strange "donuts on a rope" contrails seen over several western states. Sources at Holloman have reported several C-5A Galaxy cargo aircraft off loading shrouded aircraft into closely guarded hangars at night, and there are also reports of a new secret test facility, including a "very long" runway being built near Carizzozo, New Mexico.

One source said that the goings on at the Groom Lake facility in Nevada are becoming so well publicized that the Air Force is relocating all of its secret testing to a new "Groom Lake" in New Mexico.

Although there may be many reasons to suggest that the crash near Las Luz may have not been an F-117, hard evidence compels us to say that in all likely hood it probably was. Sightings of the aircraft before it crashed and photographs taken of the wreckage reveal that the aircraft was an F-117A. (See photo) Although most of the wreckage is unidentifiable, the distinctive tail of the F-117 is visible. Even though the tail has been twisted around at a strange angle, the tail is easily identifiable as that of a F-117.

The crash in New Mexico is only the fourth crash of an F-117. According to Air Force spokeswoman Capt. Monica Aloisio, "the first was a prototype on its acceptance flight and was being flown by a Lockheed test pilot when it crashed. The pilot survived. The second crash occurred near Bakersfield California on July 11th 1986, (which was monitored by many military monitors in the area). The pilot was killed in the Bakersfield crash. The third crash occurred on October 14, 1987 at Nellis AFB, Nevada killing the pilot". Aloisio said she did not know the causes of the crashes, however several have been unofficially attributed to pilot fatigue and were some of the main reasons the program was brought into the light of public scrutiny.

## INTERCEPTS TOUCHING BASE

Profile: Luke AFB, AZ  
Location: Phoenix, Arizona  
Radio Call Sign: LUKE

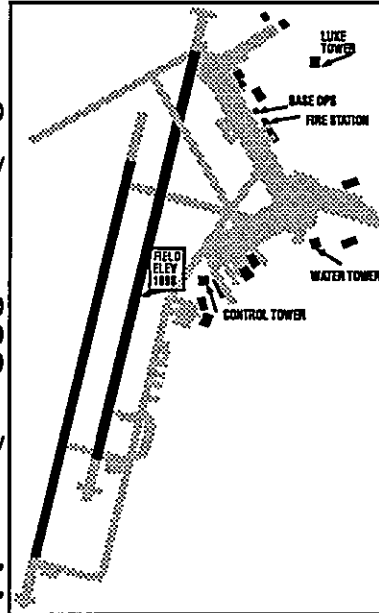
Luke air base is located 20 miles WNW of Phoenix. Zip code 85309-5000, phone (602) 856-7411. Luke is an ACC base (formerly TAC). Base activated 1941, named for 2nd Lt. Frank Luke, Jr., observation-balloon-busting ace of WWI and first American aviator to receive the Medal of Honor, killed in action September 29, 1918, near Murvaux, France. Luke is the largest fighter training base in the world, conducts USAF and allied aircrew training in the F-15E and F-16. Home of the 58th Fighter Wing, F-15 and F-16 operations, 944th Fighter Gp. (AFRES), F-16 operations; 607th Control Sqdn., forward air control operations. Area 4,197 acres, plus 2.7 million-acre range at Gila Bend, Ariz. Altitude 1,090 ft. Military 5,600; civilians 1,400. Payroll \$171 million. Housing: 95 officer, 779 enlisted, 301 transient (162 VOQ, 99 VAQ, 40 TLF). 40-bed hospital.

### FLIGHT OPERATIONS

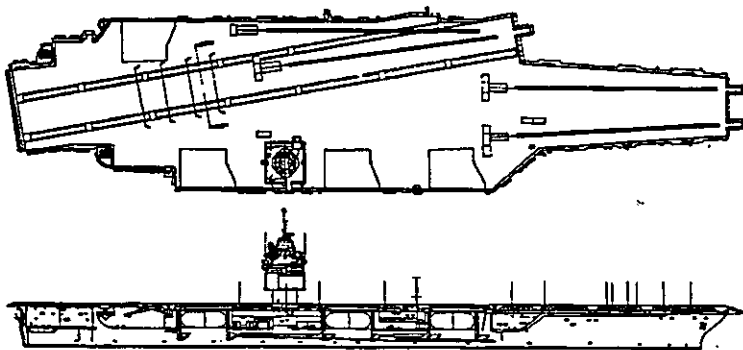
ATIS: 269.900  
Tower: 289.600/119.100  
App/Dep: 301.500/120.500  
Approaches: 391.200  
Clearance Delv: 395.000/  
119.800  
Meteo: 375.200  
AR-307 primary: 276.500  
AR-603 primary: 238.900  
AR-647H primary: 283.900  
AR-647L primary: 295.400  
AR (all) secondary: 319.500  
Bagdad Range: 296.300  
Dispatcher: 372.200  
Ground Ctl: 335.800/  
121.400  
Sells Range: 379.400  
ACC CP: 381.300  
Air Tactical: 254.500,  
276.900, 308.900, 316.700,  
373.100  
Arizona Pete Ctl: 236.200, 254.200, 260.800, 269.800, 270.200  
Gila Bend Range: 272.100, 296.500, 303.100, 308.700, 311.300  
NORAD OPS, Sierra Pete: 254.200, 260.800, 270.200, 364.200  
O'Grady GCI Ops: 286.200, 321.200, 358.200

### GROUND OPERATIONS

Security: 163.4875  
Fire/Crash: 173.5875  
Nuclear Weapons Systems: 167.850, 168.450  
OSI: 138.075, 139.165, 138.175  
Gunnery Range: 120.550, 277.100, 296.300



## INTERCEPTS FACT FILE



### U.S.S. Enterprise Nuclear-Powered Attack Aircraft Carrier (CVN 65)

#### Editors Notes:

The Enterprise was the largest warship ever built at the time of her construction and is only rivaled in size by the nuclear-powered "Nimitz" class ships. The Enterprise was the flagship of Task Force One during Operation Sea Orbit when the carrier, the nuclear-powered cruiser Long Beach (CGN 9) and the nuclear-powered frigate Bainbridge (DLGN 25) circumnavigated the globe in 1964 cruising more than 30,000 miles in 64 days (underway 57 days) without refueling. Built to a modified "Forrestal" Class design, the Enterprise's most distinctive feature is the island structure. Nuclear propulsion eliminated requirements for smoke stacks and boiler air intakes, reducing the size of the superstructures, and reducing vulnerability to battle damage, radio-activity and biological agents. Rectangular Fixed-array radar antennas ("billboards") are mounted

on sides of the island; electronic countermeasures (ECM) antennas ring the cone-shaped upper levels of the island structure. The Enterprise is fitted with the Naval Tactical Data System (NTDS), in addition to the SPS-32 and SPS-33 "billboard" radar systems. The Enterprise is also equipped with the SPS-10 and SPS-12 search radars and various navigation, radar and communications antennas including FLTSATCOM antennas.

Builder: Newport News Shipbuilding  
Commissioned: 25 November 1961  
Displacement, tons: 75,700 standard; 89,600 full load  
Length, feet (meters): 1,040 (317.0) wl: 1,123 (341.3)  
Beam, feet (meters): 133 (40.5)  
Draft, feet (meters): 335.8 (10.8)  
Flight deck width, feet (meters): 257 (78.3) maximum  
Catapults: 4 Steam  
Aircraft: approx 95  
Missile launchers: 3 Basic Point Defence Missile System (BPDMS) launchers with Sea Sparrow missiles  
Main engines: 4 geared steam turbines (Westinghouse): approx 280,000 shp; 4 shafts  
Nuclear reactors: 8 pressurized-water cooled A2W (Westinghouse)  
Speed, knots: 35  
Compliment: 3,100 (162 officers, approx 2,940 enlisted men) plus 2,400 assigned to attack air wing for a total of 5,500



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## Intercepts Frequency File

### More registered monitors!

IMNS-2025 Barry DeFuria Sarnac Lake, NY. Equipment: Pro-2006, BC-100XL, Kenwood R-2000  
AOR 1000 XLT  
Monitors: all military 1-30 MHz  
225-400 MHz says there have been many changes in local (Plattsburg AFB) freqs since June 1st

IMNS-2026 John F. Galo Belleville, IL  
Equipment: Pro-2006, Uniden BC200 XLT, AOR1000 XLT, DX-440, Drake R-8  
Monitors Scott AFB and Lambert Airport

IMNS-2027 Bob Burdick, Meriden, CT  
Equipment: Pro-2005 AR-1000, BC 20/20, Yaesu FRG-7700  
Future plans include buying a AR-3000  
Monitors military and civilian aircraft 10-1300 MHz

### Canadian Navy

Robert Smith (IMNS-2014) writes in with what he says are some changes in the Navy HICOM Pacific Fleet's frequencies. Robert monitors the Navy from Nanaimo, B.C. and says the new frequencies are 4.114 MHz (changed from 4.416 MHz), 8.776 MHz (changed from 8.778 MHz), and 13.115 MHz (changed from 13.181MHz). Robert also passes on these intercepts.  
6.716 MHz Vancouver Military Ch. D3H  
9.010 MHz Vancouver Military Ch. D3I  
11.236 MHz Vancouver Military Ch. D3J  
4.422 MHz Vancouver Military Ch. ?  
6.693 MHz Vancouver Military Ch. ?  
2.716 MHz Vancouver Military Ch ?  
5.718 MHz Vancouver Military Ch ?  
NORAD activity  
364.200 DRAGNET U calling BIGFOOT  
Surveillance/PURSE 01 calling YEAGER  
274.400 PAWN01 & 02 working YEAGER  
235.900 BANDSAW K relaying through DEERHUNTER to Tinker AFB

### Stone Monitor

From Kentucky John Stone writes us and asks if Intercepts has done any testing on the AOR 1000 portable scanner and how well it works for military monitoring. I'll tell you, John getting a sample to test from AOR is about as easy as getting pictures of the TR-3A Black Manta. However, the ICOM is a fine portable for military monitoring on the go. So if any AOR users out there want to send in their impressions, tips and tricks for operating the AOR-1000, we'll publish them here.

Next month we will be having a review of the new Realistic PRO-43 portable scanner, which features two hundred channels and full 225-400 MHz military aviation band scanning capability. The friendly folks at Tandy say they have a new winner and have promised us a sample for review.

### "BIG RED"

from Lancaster, California, writes in with some call sign information. Big Red says he enjoyed Gary Moncur's (IMNS-2013) listings in the June issue of Intercepts and sends us in these additions.  
ACME: F-16s from Edwards AFB on ALCM test missions  
AXEMEN: EA6B Prowlers of VAQ-309 (Navy Reserve unit and part of Air Wing

30) flying ECM missions.

BANGER: VAW-117

AGAR: 4950 Test Wing from Wright Patterson AFB, Ohio, flying C-135, C-141, and T-39s on test missions.

MISTY: VX-5 Air Test & Evaluation Squadron 5, NAC China Lake

COSO: NAWC China Lake station aircraft F-18s, A-6s, MU-2s

VANDY: VX-4 Pt Mugu Test Squadron F-14s, F-18s air to air test

RAIDER: F-18s of VFA-125 Strike fighter squadron from Lemoore NAS

LOBO: VFA-305 Navy Reserve from Pt Mugu

FIREHAWKS: HH-60H Combat SAR Reserve at Pt Mugu

Red recommends that every military monitor rush out and obtain a copy of "Military Aircraft Serials of North America". Red says that it is an excellent source of aircraft serial numbers.

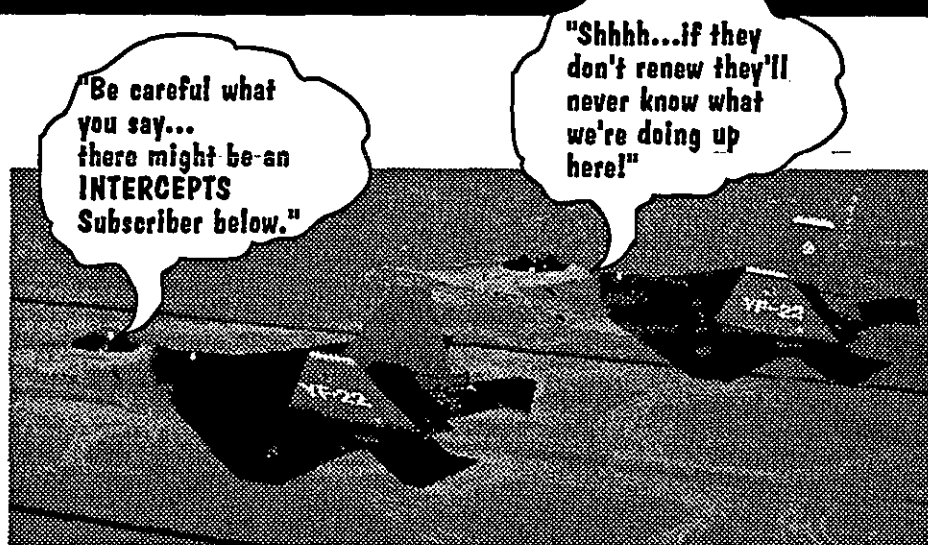
### BERMUDA BIRDS

Fleck Wilkin writes in and says he is still having trouble finding and monitoring FLTSATCOM satellites. Fleck is using a ICOM R-7000, Grove Scanner Beam and a 10db inline preamp on very low loss coax cable. Fleck would like to know the positions of the FLTSATCOM satellites from his post in Bermuda so he will know where to point his antenna. Fleck, the actual posi-

tions of the FLTSATCOM satellites are classified, but you can ferret out their approximate positions by monitoring 261.400, 262.400 and 263.400 MHz (nbfm). Program these frequencies into your receiver, point your antenna due West and slowly turn it through South until you swing it back to due East. On the frequencies are broadcast steady "white noise" which will sound like a open carrier. These transmissions are used by Navy ships in much the same way you'll be using them, to help them find the birds from any place in the world. The FLTSATCOM satellites are parked in a high geosynchronous orbit over the equator, so you should point your antenna to the south., however they can be moved out of their orbits to provide coverage in certain areas, especially during a conflict.

Although the uplink transmissions to FLTSATCOM satellites are very directional, the downlink is not, so you don't have to be pointed directly at a satellite to hear it. I have received reports of monitors who have easily received FLTSATCOM transmission using a hand held and a robber ducky antenna. Patience and diligent monitoring is the key to success. If there are any old pro FLTSATCOM monitors out there who have some tips to pass on to Fleck, send them in!

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Since, we want as many Intercepts members as possible on computer network, the Intercepts BBS Open house we be held over until October.

If you are interested in seeing what the Intercepts BBS is all about, drop us a line and receive a password that will grant you free access for a limited time!

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Hurricane season is in full swing and Intercepts members can find the latest frequencies for monitoring hurricane hunters, disaster networks, Red Cross SW communications, Navy and Coast Guard hurricane operations, all posted on the BBS in the *Frequency File*.

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In the *Intercepts* file, BBS members can find the latest reports, sightings, rumors and speculations about the secret stealth aircraft that are grabbing our attention and headlines around the world. Read about it first in the *Intercepts* file.

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## BACK ISSUES

Sept. '91- Chasing the Black Manta (TR-3A)  
Oct. '91- Persian Gulf 2  
Nov. '91- Above Top Secret TR-3A Black Manta  
Dec. '91- FLTSATCOM Ears In The Sky  
Jan. '92- Flying In A Gas Station (Air To Air Refueling)  
Feb. '92- Military Identifiers Explained  
March '92- Military Radio Voice Brevity Codes Explained  
April '92- Chasing Auroras And Other Secret Stealth Aircraft  
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